Safaa El Ouafi

User Experience Researcher

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SUMMARY

User Experience Researcher at Decathlon, previously at Alan and Algolia. In tech since 2019, after ten years in teaching and learning programmes. Mixed-methods researcher, from generative and strategic research to usability testing. I build research systems, continuous discovery practices and AI agents so that product teams keep learning from their users.

SKILLS

Research methods: Generative, evaluative and strategic research, mixed methods, user interviews, diary studies, field studies, usability testing, surveys, card sorting, jobs-to-be-done, segmentation

Research operations: Research repository (atomic research), continuous discovery, research rituals and roadmap, insight synthesis, workshop facilitation, stakeholder management, mentoring

AI: AI-assisted analysis, AI agents for product teams, evaluation of AI tools

Tools: Airtable, Notion, Figma, FigJam, Miro, Gemini, Claude, Lovable

EXPERIENCE

Senior UX Researcher, Decathlon Digital

Paris, France | Sep 2023 – Present

- Built a research system and a continuous discovery practice for 5 product teams: atomic research repository, rituals, practice roadmap.
- Co-led the AI in Design study: survey, segmentation, interviews and a 3-month diary study with 20 users. Turned a request to "buy a tool" into an adoption programme; presented to 300–400 designers.
- Led a strategic study on how products are prioritised into development (sports leaders, PMOs, product managers).
- Built AI agents for product managers and researchers; founded a community of about 20 UX researchers in 4 cities.

Training and volunteering, Le Wagon, The Design Crew

Paris, France | Sep 2022 – Sep 2023

- Data analysis (Le Wagon) and advanced product design (The Design Crew).

Senior User Researcher, Alan

Paris, France | Sep 2021 – Sep 2022

- Alan Mind (mental health): studied how people in France picture therapy, to make seeking help feel normal.
- Alan Clinic: researched adoption and use cases of the medical chat. Alan Clear: researched buying glasses online.

Instructional Designer, then User Researcher, Algolia

Paris, France | Feb 2019 – Sep 2021

- Designed the Algolia Academy and partner certifications.
- Researched the customer learning journey with Customer Success (pre-sales to onboarding); built learner personas.

Programme Manager, Simplon

Paris, France | Sep 2018 – Dec 2018

- Built hiring partnerships (Orange, Microsoft, Capgemini, Accenture, Apple) so learners left with job contracts.

Programme Manager, Next Academy

Kuala Lumpur, Malaysia and Singapore | Apr 2018 – Aug 2018

- Set up coding bootcamp programmes and improved them from one cohort to the next.

Programme Manager, RBK Jordan

Amman, Jordan | Feb 2017 – Mar 2018

- Coding bootcamp training refugees to become software engineers. Audited and rebuilt the programme; led educators across 3 cohorts of about 30 learners.
- Added English and digital literacy from employer feedback; ran one-to-ones and restorative justice circles.

French Teacher and Coordinator, French Embassy

Amman, Jordan | Oct 2015 – Aug 2016

Teacher and Instructional Designer, Schools and companies

France | Sep 2008 – Oct 2015

- Taught Arabic, then French, to learners from age 3 to engineers at Thales. Founded intercultural cooking workshops.

EDUCATION

Master 1 (M1), Language Didactics and Language Policy, Université du Maine, 2016
Licence (Bachelor), Arabic Language and Literature (LLCE)
Advanced Product Design, The Design Crew, 2023
Data Analysis, Le Wagon, 2022
UX Research, Cousto, 2021

LANGUAGES

French (native), English (C2, fluent), Arabic (C1, advanced), Spanish (B1, intermediate)